Government, Records and Public Authority

East Detroit | Reference memorandum

City and County of East Detroit

November 2030

Governing structure

East Detroit's charter places municipal and county duties under one elected government. City-county departments report through the local executive and council. Several services are performed by separate public bodies with their own boards, revenues and statutory duties. County status brings the administration of state-supervised human services into the local government, but it does not change federal benefit rules.

Colorado's Local Government Handbook describes municipal, county, school and special district powers. The Broomfield constitutional amendment record provides a Colorado example of forming a city and county. Michigan's Charter Counties Act, MCL 45.515 provides a useful comparison for transferring municipal functions through agreements.

Budgets and taxes

Colorado's Taxpayer's Bill of Rights (TABOR), article X, section 20 of the state constitution, constrains local tax increases, debt and certain revenue decisions. A new local tax or multiyear debt may re-

quire voter approval. An agency's operating income and a city's general fund are not interchangeable. Colorado Legislative Council: TABOR overview (2026).

Human services

Colorado uses a **state-supervised, county-administered** system. County workers deliver many direct services and make program determinations under state and federal rules. A local digital service therefore needs both the county's operating process and the program authority that governs eligibility, appeals and state-system access. Legislative Council: Human Services Delivery Structure (2025) and Colorado Department of Human Services: Counties.

Records and public access

The Colorado Open Records Act (CORA), C.R.S. §§ 24-72-201 through 206, generally opens public records to inspection with specified exceptions. It does not make confidential medical, student, library or criminal justice records available as a single citywide file. Custodians must identify which law governs each request. Colorado General Assembly: CORA law summary (2025).

The Colorado Criminal Justice Records Act, C.R.S. § 24-72-301 et seq. governs criminal justice records separately. The Colorado library privacy law, C.R.S. § 24-90-119 restricts disclosure of records showing who used library materials or services. School records are governed by FERPA and its regulations, together with Colorado student data privacy rules. For covered healthcare organizations, the HIPAA Privacy Rule governs protected health information.

Digital services and accessibility

The federal Americans with Disabilities Act, Title II, applies to state and local government services. The Department of Justice's 2024 web and mobile rule generally requires WCAG 2.1 Level AA. The federal compliance date for public entities serving at least 50,000 people was extended to **April 26, 2027**; special district governments have a different deadline. DOJ: Title II web and mobile rule,

updated 2026. Colorado also has its own government technology accessibility requirements under Colorado HB21-1110 and related state rules.

Electronic records and signatures can be valid without turning all transactions into automated decisions. The legal status of a record, the authority to act on it and a resident's right to a review are separate matters.

Information exchange: Estonia's X-tee

Estonia's X-tee connects records held by different agencies. Members describe the services they provide. Another member obtains access through an agreement with the source organization. Requests are authenticated, authorized, encrypted, signed and logged. X-tee transports information; it does not take ownership of each organization's records. Estonian Information System Authority: X-tee and Introduction to X-tee, including membership and agreements.

The operational distinction is important in a city-county. An address office may verify where a parcel lies, but a school district decides school enrollment, a housing authority decides federal assistance and a court controls its case records. Technology can carry an agreed request without transferring those decisions to another agency.

Independent bodies and shared services

Colorado special districts can have their own taxing, borrowing, property and service responsibilities. Examples include libraries, fire protection, water and sanitation. The regional transit district is governed by an elected board; public hospitals and housing authorities may have separate commissions and federal contracts. Local Government Handbook, RTD board office and Colorado water and sanitation law overview.

A shared service may therefore involve the same household but several official records: a municipal address, a school enrollment record, a county benefits case, a housing voucher file and a clinical chart. Each record has a different responsible agency and legal basis.